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What *do* women want? We take a look into the minds of tech-savvy women to find out what they want to buy, and why

Robert Sovereign-Smith

"Ooh, look: a pink laptop! I want!"

"Computers are so boring... I'd rather be out shopping!"

Sound familiar? All guys (or should we say MCPs) should immediately identify with this. Much of what follows will be a pin-prick deflating a lot of male egos. Technology has fallen as the last remaining bastion of male dominance. Two of every 10 of you reading this article is female. That's the impressive demographic of our readers, given the fact that we certainly aren't a complete beginner's guide to technology. This fact alone tells us that the gender bias of technology is ending, if it hasn't already.

Between three and four years ago, technology companies found themselves in a quandary. While trying to sell their products, apparently, salesmen (or should we say salespeople?) often took it for granted that female customers knew nothing of tech. This resulted in a loss of sales, because no-one, male or female, likes to be treated like a clueless moron. It was found that salespeople who treated men and women alike, and only explained features when they were asked for an explanation, were the ones who sold the most. Thus began the end of sexism in all things tech.

Women today are coding much of the software we use, running tech companies, playing games, and are as tech-savvy as can be expected. We conducted a survey of as many women we knew—from engineers to artists, dancers to technical writers,



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